

PRODUCT TEARDOWN

Subspace.money

Subscribe to anything, delivered in minutes

Submitted by: **Dhruv Singh** | May 2026

Company Snapshot

What it is India's first subscription marketplace — buy shared Netflix, Prime, Spotify at 80% off. Also: rentals in 10 min & discounted gift cards.	Key Numbers Rs. 36.5 Cr ARR (FY25) · Zero external funding · Bootstrapped & profitable · 90%+ ops via AI agents
Core ICP Cost-conscious 18-28 year olds — college students, young professionals wanting cheaper OTT & productivity tools	Key Moat Network effects (group sharing stickier at scale) + Negotiate API for automated price negotiation + India-first positioning

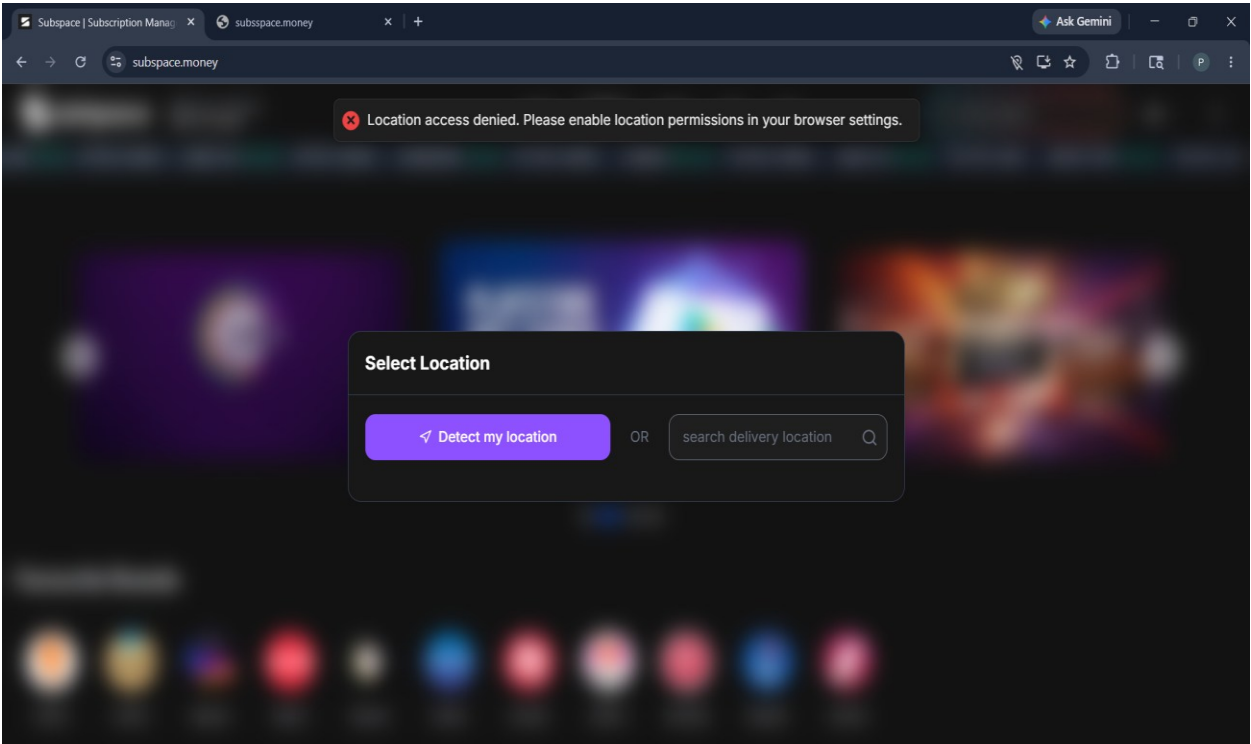
5 Feedbacks at a Glance

#	Title	Pillar	Priority
1	Location Gate Blocks Entire App	UX	P0 — Fix immediately
2	Login Wall Before Value Proof	UX	P0 — High drop-off
3	Homepage Identity Crisis	GTM / ICP	P1 — Positioning leak
4	Checkout Trust Vacuum	Features / UX	P1 — Conversion killer
5	Rating Inflation + Broken Search	Features	P2 — Trust erosion

Prioritisation Logic: P0 items are user-facing friction at the top of the funnel — they kill conversion before the product even gets a chance to show value. P1 items erode trust and positioning at the moment of purchase. P2 affects long-term retention and platform health.

Detailed Feedback

#1 Location Gate Blocks the Entire App [UX]	
OBSERVED	On opening subspace.money, the app immediately fires a browser location permission prompt. If the user denies it — which most privacy-conscious users will — a full-screen "Location access denied. Please enable location permissions in your browser settings." error blocks all content. The entire homepage goes inaccessible. Subscriptions, gift cards, and groups — none of which require location — become unreachable.
PROBLEM	Subspace's core value (shared Netflix/Prime at 80% off) has zero dependency on a user's physical location. Location is only needed for the Rentals vertical (10-min gadget delivery, select cities). Gating the ENTIRE product behind a feature used by a small minority of users creates a massive top-of-funnel leak. A first-time visitor with genuine intent to save on subscriptions will simply bounce — and likely never return. This also creates an immediate trust deficit: "Why does a subscription app need my location?"
SHIP INSTEAD	Decouple location permission from core app access. Only request location when the user explicitly navigates to the Rentals tab. For the homepage and Subscriptions/Gift Cards flows, location should be optional with a "Set location for rentals" nudge rather than a hard gate. This preserves the Rentals UX while eliminating a conversion-killing blocker for the majority use case.



Screenshot: Location access denied error — entire app blocked on permission deny

#2 Login Wall Before Value Proof [UX]

OBSERVED

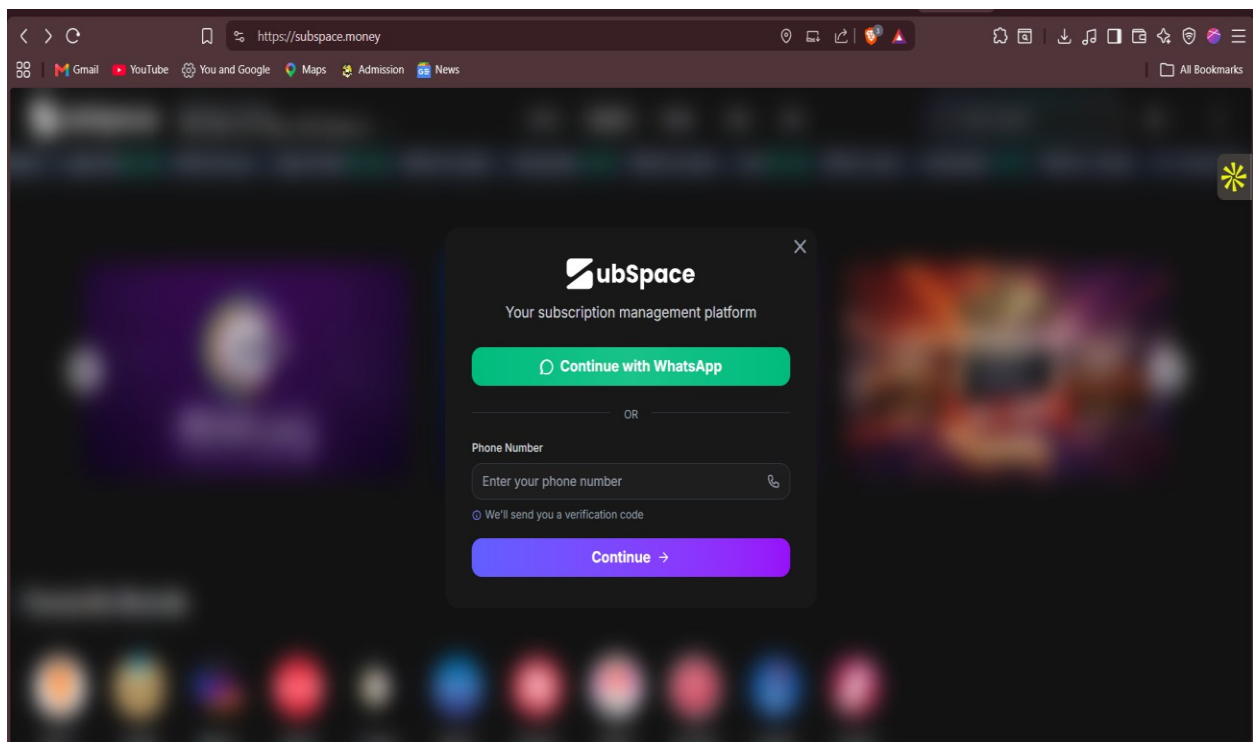
When landing on subspace.money, the entire homepage content is blurred and a login modal instantly overlays it, asking for WhatsApp or phone number authentication before any product exploration is possible. There is no value proposition shown, no "you'll save X/month" calculator, no subscription catalogue preview — just two buttons asking for personal contact info.

PROBLEM

The user has no reason to trust Subspace yet. They don't know what they're signing up for, what subscriptions are available, or what the actual savings are. This is especially damaging for a financial platform where trust is the primary purchase driver. Asking for a phone number before demonstrating any value is a conversion killer. Competitors like Zepto communicate their entire value ("delivery in 10 min") before forcing sign-up; Subspace communicates nothing.

SHIP INSTEAD

Allow unauthenticated browsing for the Subscriptions catalogue and Gift Cards section — let users see real listings (Netflix groups at Rs. 163/month, etc.) before prompting login. Add a pre-login savings calculator: "Enter your current subscriptions → See how much you'd save with Subspace." Gate only the purchase/join action behind authentication. This gives users a reason to sign up before asking them to.



Screenshot: Blurred homepage with instant login modal — no value shown before asking for phone number

#3 Homepage Looks Like a Cashback App, Not a Subscription Platform [GTM / ICP]

OBSERVED

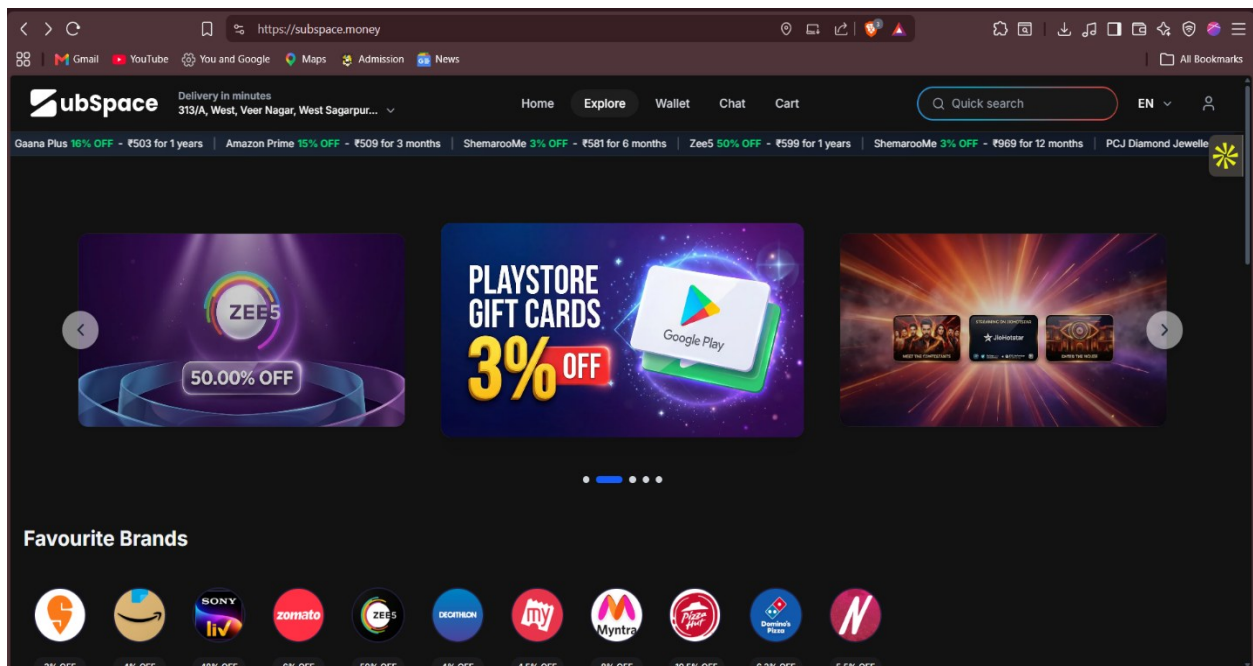
The homepage "Favourite Brands" section prominently features Zomato (6% off), Pizza Hut (10.5% off), Domino's (6.3% off), Myntra (8% off), Decathlon (4.5% off) — these are food delivery and fashion brands tied to gift card discounts, not subscription services. The hero carousel leads with ZEE5 50% off and Google Play Gift Cards at 3% off. A user landing here for the first time would reasonably conclude this is a cashback/coupon site like CashKaro or GoPaisa — not a subscription management or sharing platform.

PROBLEM

The homepage is miscommunicating Subspace's actual differentiated value. The Negotiate API, group subscription sharing, and 80% savings on Netflix/Spotify are genuine moats — but they're invisible above the fold. Instead, the homepage leads with 3-10% gift card discounts that any cashback app also offers. This positioning leak means Subspace acquires users with cashback intent, who will churn when they realise the core product is subscription sharing — and it fails to attract the high-intent subscription-heavy user who would get the most value.

SHIP INSTEAD

Restructure the homepage hierarchy: lead with subscription sharing (the real moat) — show live savings on Netflix, Prime, Spotify with real group prices. Push gift cards to a secondary "Also save on" section. Add a simple value statement above the fold: "Split Netflix with 3 others. Pay Rs. 163/month instead of Rs. 649." This speaks directly to the core ICP (young, cost-conscious users) and differentiates from cashback apps instantly.



Screenshot: Homepage 'Favourite Brands' showing Zomato, Pizza Hut, Domino's — reads like a cashback site

#4 Checkout Shows Empty Groups with Opaque Expiry Dates [Features / UX]

OBSERVED

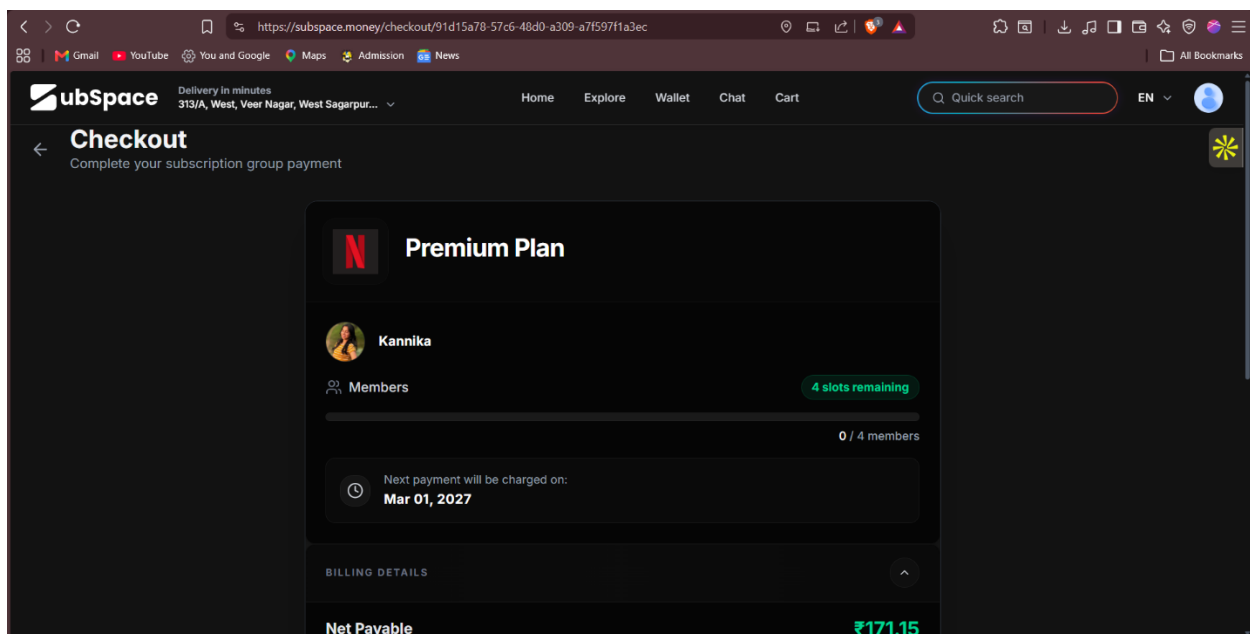
On the Netflix Premium checkout page, the group being joined shows "0 / 4 members" — meaning zero people have joined yet, including the admin. Additionally, the "Next payment will be charged on: Mar 01, 2027" date is displayed — which is 9+ months from the time of checkout (May 2026). There is no explanation for why this date is so far ahead, no breakdown of what was paid vs. what period is covered, and no indication of what happens between now and March 2027.

PROBLEM

A user paying Rs. 171 is joining an empty group with a stranger as admin and a renewal date nearly a year away with zero context. This creates three compounding trust problems: (1) Will the admin actually show up and share access? (2) Is the Mar 2027 date a bug or intentional — what period does this payment cover? (3) What happens if the admin goes inactive in the next 9 months? Combined, this is a high-anxiety, low-trust checkout experience for a transaction that requires the user to share a streaming account with strangers. Play Store reviews confirm users regularly face issues with admins going inactive or removing members with no recourse.

SHIP INSTEAD

Add a checkout trust layer: (a) Show a "Verified admin" badge with response rate and join success rate, not just a star rating. (b) Explain the billing period clearly: "You're paying for [X months] upfront — next renewal Mar 2027." (c) Add an escrow-style protection message: "If you don't receive access within 24 hours, you'll get a full refund automatically." This converts a high-anxiety transaction into a confident one.



Screenshot: Checkout showing 0/4 members and Mar 2027 renewal — zero trust signals at point of payment

#5 Rating Inflation and a Search Box That Searches the Wrong Thing [Features]

OBSERVED

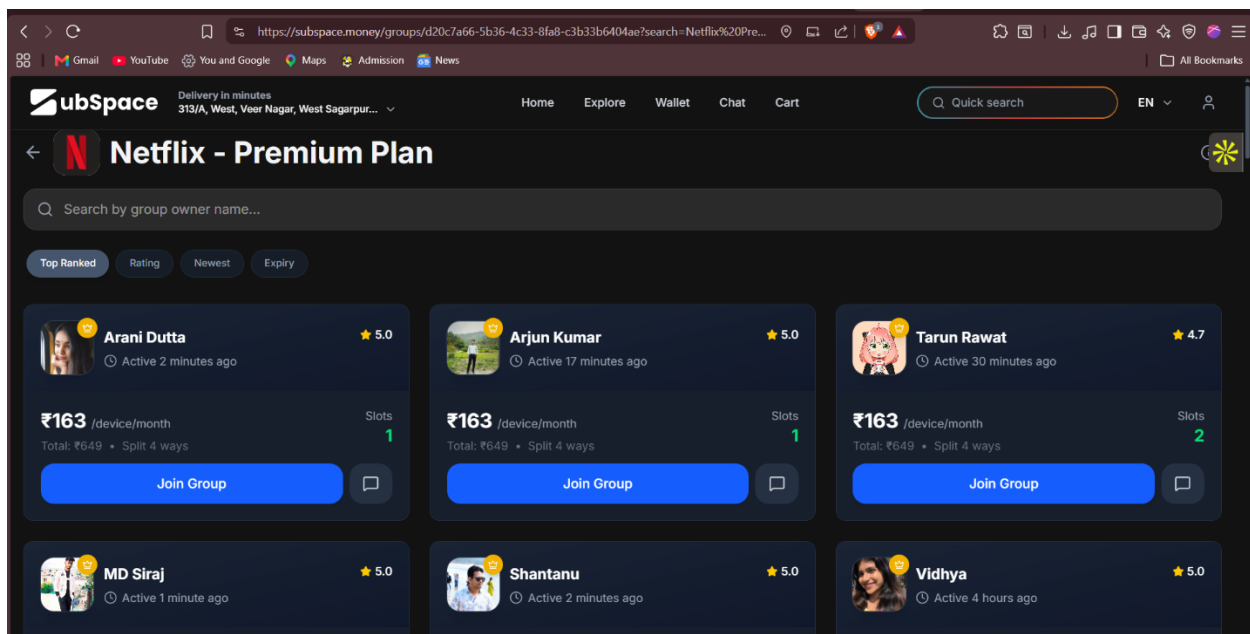
On the Netflix Premium group listing page, virtually all admins have 5.0 / 5.0 star ratings. Out of 6 visible admins, 5 are rated exactly 5.0 and one is 4.7 — there is no differentiation. The only sorting options available are "Top Ranked", "Rating", "Newest", and "Expiry". The search bar prompts "Search by group owner name" — requiring the user to know a stranger's first name to find a specific group.

PROBLEM

When every admin has a perfect 5.0 rating, the rating system provides zero signal. A user cannot identify a genuinely reliable admin from a newcomer. This is a known marketplace problem: without enough negative reviews (because unhappy users churn rather than review), ratings inflate to the ceiling. The broken search paradigm compounds this — searching "by group owner name" is meaningless when users are evaluating strangers. Users actually want to filter by: longest-running groups, fastest credential delivery, fewest complaints, or price per month — none of which are surfaced. This pushes users toward random selection, eroding the trust that a marketplace needs to thrive.

SHIP INSTEAD

(1) Replace the simple star rating with a multi-signal trust score: delivery success rate (% of members who got access), average response time, active tenure on platform, and total members served. This creates genuine differentiation and is harder to game. (2) Replace "Search by group owner name" with filters that matter: Price (low to high), Active since (longest running), Slots available, and a "Verified admin" toggle for power users. This turns a broken search into a genuine discovery engine.



Screenshot: Netflix group listing — 5 out of 6 admins rated exactly 5.0/5.0, search by 'group owner name'

Frameworks Used

This teardown draws on Porter's Five Forces (competitive moat analysis, trust as switching cost), Jobs-to-be-Done (identifying what the user is actually hiring Subspace for at each screen), and standard conversion funnel analysis (top-of-funnel leaks vs. mid-funnel trust gaps). Each observation was grounded in direct product usage and cross-referenced with Play Store user reviews (3,200+ reviews, 3.6/5 rating) to validate that observed frictions translate to real user pain, not edge cases.

All 5 feedbacks span different product pillars (UX x2, GTM/ICP x1, Features x2) and are sequenced from highest conversion impact (P0) to platform health (P2), reflecting how a Day 1 PM would actually prioritise the backlog.